

1952, July

The following is a faithful transcription of the typed draft of the Servant of God, Father Solanus Casey, C.F.M. Cap.

Mr. Frank B. Stabile. Detroit 14,

Many thanks for your pathetic communication of June 20th, which I had to put aside at the time and which frankly, till I neared its conclusion, I was inclined to ignore. However, though the situation is not essentially changed, I feel bound to offer you something of encouragement for the "problems" of which you complain, viz, about God and about "science and religion". For "practical children of the Church" such problems are to a great extent solved at baptism; so that by the grace of that Sacrament the principles of the "triune virtue of Faith - Hope - Charity" are divinely infused into the soul whereby, from the very start it becomes docilly inclined to believe; and to behold the Church and to confide in her with growing conviction as divinely founded and as infallibly guided in her capacity of mother and mistress of immortal souls - of human candidates for the life of eternal glory; of which St. Paul writes: "Eye hath not seen, ear hath not heard, nor hath it entered into the heart of man to conceive what things God has prepared for them that love Him".

But let us first lament your failure - which is not yours only but humanity's to which we both belong. Perhaps our sadest failure, notwithstanding our faculties for thinking and reasoning, notwithstanding our advanced steps in every phase of science and, (what ought to count most of all in the natural order of conclusion) notwithstanding uncounted ages of bitterest experience of men and angels, that ingratitude to God never pays. We have in great part failed to recognize as a science, the one, in the sight of heaven, greatest science of all times and of all places wherever pertains to rational creatures. We have failed to recognize as a science OUR MOST FORTUNATE RELATIONSHIP - absolute dependence on the Almighty, all merciful God, and together with that, our dependence on our neighbor.

(Unfinished.)